priorities, while also laying the foundations for collective action. The early decades of the Bretton Woods governance regimes provide particularly apt evidence:

> Cabinet ministers or the equivalent, working in the same issue-area, initially from a relatively small number of relatively rich countries, got together to make rules. Trade ministers dominated [the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT)]; finance ministers ran the IMF; defense and foreign ministers met at [the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO)]; central bankers at the Bank for International Settlements (BIS). They negotiated in secret, then reported their agreements to national legislatures and publics. Until recently, they were largely unchallenged.[87]

Subsequently, the major powers pioneered and increasingly substituted a second variant of club model politics that used smaller steering groups to preset favorable outcomes in international institutions and regimes. These apex groups of five or seven or ten major powers have regularized the informal mechanisms necessary to ensure that the interests of dominant powers are advanced and protected in international regimes.[88]

At the same time, Keohane and Nye acknowledge that a major factor weakening the club system of trade politics—which also applies to other Bretton Woods regimes—are demands by developing countries for greater participation at the high tables of policymaking. Their leaders are “ambivalent about the regimes, suspicious about the implications of rich country leadership, and resentful of the existence of club rules, made by the rich, that they did not help to establish.”[89] There were numerous attempts by emerging or developing countries to reform the global economic governance system ranging from the New International Economic Order (NIEO) through the UN Conference on Trade and Development (UNCTAD) in the 1970s[90] to Japan’s challenge to the Washington consensus from the late 1980s through the Asian financial crisis.[91] None of them, however, succeeded in drastically transforming the basic thrust of the international governance structure.

The shift in international power evident in the first decades of the twenty-first century exacerbated these tensions between incumbent Western powers and the large emerging and developing economies.[92] As their economic heft and growth rates surged, rising powers challenged financial governance institutions such as the IMF and World Bank, which in principle allocate voting and quota shares broadly by economic size. Yet despite the fact that some BRICS economies have grown more than ten times since the Bretton